Teacher : Children, tell me where Madurai is?

Students : It is in Tamil Nadu.

Teacher : Good. Where is Tamil Nadu?

Students : In India ...teacher.

Teacher : Now tell me where India is?

Students : India is in the continent of Asia, teacher.

Teacher : Excellent! Can anyone tell me where is the continent of Asia?

Students: Yes teacher. It is on the Earth.

Teacher : Ok children, tell me where the Earth is located?

Students : (Remain silent and after sometime they reply in chorus) No. We don't know.

Teacher : Now, let me explain. The Earth is the third planet in the Solar System. The solar system is in the galaxy. It is named as the Milkyway Galaxy. There are millions of such galaxies in the Universe.

Iniya : Teacher, shall I say the address of our Earth?

Teacher : Address of our Earth? It's interesting Iniya. Tell us the address.

Iniya : Miss. Earth,
No.3. Solar System,
Milkyway Galaxy,
Universe.

(Everyone clapped and the teacher appreciates Iniya.)

Teacher : That was very good Iniya. Now let us know about the solar system, galaxy, the Universe and all other bodies in detail in this lesson.

Numerous stars and celestial bodies came into existence by a massive explosion called the **Big Bang**. These celestial bodies together are called the **Universe**. It is also referred to as the **Cosmos**. The stars that you see are so far away that they appear to be small, but they are really huge in size.



The study of the Universe is called **Cosmology**. The term Cosmos is derived from the Greek word 'Kosmos'.

1. Universe



The Universe is a vast expanse of space. Most astronomers believe that the Universe came into existence after the Big Bang explosion that took place about 15 billion years ago. The universe consists of billions of galaxies, stars, planets, comets, asteroids, meteoroids and natural satellites. These are collectively called as celestial bodies, which are located far away from each other. A Light year is the unit used to measure the distance between the celestial bodies.

Galaxy

A galaxy is a huge cluster of stars which are held together by gravitational force. Most of the galaxies are scattered in space,